

Dr. Rainer Widmann

Data Scientist

Profile

Data Scientist focused on building and validating models that analyze pricing, product, and delivery/logistics factors in e-commerce, providing insights to support operational and strategic decisions. Strong background in causal inference and experimentation.

Personal

Nationality: Austrian
Address: Rosenheim, Germany
Phone: 01794195140
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Languages

English, fluent
German, native

Interests

Customer Intelligence
Marketing Analytics
Causal Inference
Econometrics
Pricing

@ rainerwidmann.com

in LinkedIn Profile

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

09/2024–

Zooplus (E-commerce)

DATA SCIENTIST · Munich, Germany



- Built and validated customer retention models to analyze how delivery performance and logistics-related factors influence repeat purchase behavior, informing operational decisions in logistics and product management.
- Designed and executed pricing and product acceptance experiments, including power calculations, analysis, and validation, to inform pricing and assortment decisions.
- Developed a supplier evaluation approach by linking supplier-specific product experience to customer repeat purchase behavior, enabling data-driven supplier benchmarking.

08/2018-08/2024

Max Planck Institute for Innovation and Competition

ECONOMIC RESEARCHER (DATA SCIENCE FOCUS) · Munich, Germany



- Analyzed large-scale platform and behavioral data to quantify the effect of competition on individual performance of coders using causal modeling techniques.
- Built NLP pipelines on patent text data to extract, structure, and analyze innovation signals across countries and industries.
- Presented and defended analytical results to diverse audiences, translating complex empirical findings into clear narratives for economists, policymakers, and interdisciplinary collaborators.

DEGREES

2018 **Ph.D. Managerial Economics and Strategy**
NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY · United States



2012 **M.Sc. Economics**
TU VIENNA · Austria



2010 **B.A. Political Science**
UNIVERSITY OF VIENNA · Austria



SKILLS

Programming & Data: Python (pandas, scikit-learn, statsmodels, Polars), SQL, PySpark, Git, DVC

Modeling & Experimentation: Predictive modeling (regression, classification, tree-based models), A/B testing, experiment design, power analysis

Causal & Advanced Analytics: Quasi-experimental methods, causal ML, applied econometrics

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Motives, Gender, and Experience: Performance Effects in Crowdsourcing Contests. *Strategy Science*



Sexual Misconduct, Accused Scientists, and Their Research. *Review of Economics and Statistics*



The Behavioral Additionality of Government Research Grants. *International Journal of Industrial Organization*



Business Applications: Pricing & assortment, customer retention & loyalty, product experience analysis, logistics analysis

Visualization & Communication: Power BI, Tableau, Python/R visualizations (Matplotlib, ggplot2)